Pradhan_Qualitative_Survey_2026

Interview Questionnaire — Language: English (en)

> Pradhan Qualitative Survey 2026

Section A - Consent (see script)/Interview details

A.1. Target/Sample Selection ID

Note: Enter target/sample selection ID

_____

A.2. Date and time started

[___/___/_____ ___:___]

Pradhan name

_____

Gram panchayat name

_____

Block name

_____

Distict name

_____

Social category

( ) General
( ) OBC
( ) SC
( ) ST
( ) Other
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

Specify other social category:

_____
_____

A.3. Location/GIS of interview

Note: Record GPS coordinates of the interview location

[GPS Location Coordinates: _____]

Namaste. My name is **[_____]** and I am here on behalf of Morsel Research and Development (Morsel India). We are helping carry out a research study on for Tanisha Mohapatra from University of Oxford, and her supervisor, Professor David Rueda at Oxford. This project is on "Inequality & Representation: Experiences and decisions of panchayat pradhans" and it is strictly for academic research purposes, and neither we, nor the researchers are part of any commercial or political group or organization.

We are speaking with many pradhans in UP, and we will ask you to describe your experience as candidates, your motivations, and how you make decisions and implement programs. There are no right or wrong answers -- we are only interested in how you see things. This study has been reviewed by Oxford's research ethics body.

The interview will take about 30-40 minutes. We are very grateful for your time and effort. There is no payment or benefit for taking part, and there is no penalty or disadvantage if you choose not to. You can decline to answer any question, and you can stop the interview at any point, without giving any reason, without any consequence. Taking part is completely voluntary.

Your views or perspective will be kept confidential. Findings will be reported only in aggregate, anonymized form. At no point will any information that could personally identify you be released to anyone. If you take part today but change your mind later, you can contact the PI by WhatsApp or email within two months of this interview. Your responses will be deleted and left out of any further analysis. This sheet has contact information and all the details we have told you.

If you wish to give further permission, we'd like to make an audio recording of our interview. This is strictly for checking quality and ensuring that the PIs understand your views accurately. The recording is completely optional -- you can take part in the interview fully without it, you can ask us to stop at any time. Recordings can be accessed only by the PIs and supervisors and are deleted automatically two months after the interview.

Do you have any questions?

( ) Yes

( ) No

[Enumerator] Please respond to the respondent's questions and record the details.

_____

_____

Are you willing to take part?

( ) Yes - written consent

( ) Yes - oral consent

( ) No

Thank you for your time. The respondent did not consent to the interview. Please conclude and finalize the form.

With your permission, may we record, or would you prefer to proceed without the optional recording?

( ) Yes - written consent

( ) Yes - oral consent

( ) No

A.7. Random subset (50% selected to get 2 extra questions) ${A_7_calc}

( ) Yes

( ) No

A.8. How many others are present within hearing distance?

Note: Enter approximate count (0 or more)

[_____]

A.9. Any women present within hearing distance?

( ) Yes

( ) No

A.10. Place of interview

( ) GP office

( ) Pradhan residence

( ) Other

A.10. Other - Specify other place of interview:

_____

_____

Section B - Motivation to contest and prior experience

B.1. Think about the time before the 2021 elections. So around when you were deciding whether or not to contest. How did you come to stand for pradhan? What were your motivations for entering politics?

Note: Record open response

_____

B.2. In elections, candidates often know who is their important support base, and who might oppose them. Thinking of supporters and opposers within your GP, which group's support was most important for you?

Note: If they say "everyone said I should run" - ask them to break it down.

_____

B.3. What did candidates such as yourself do for the 2021 pradhan election? Did you do any activities, events, speeches, etc. or a campaign?

Note: Nudge towards specific activities, rather than general promises.

_____

B.4. What was the most important campaign activity that you think helped you win in 2021?

Note: Nudge towards specific things like approaching specific people, hosting events, distributing pamphlets.

_____

B.5. The team or small set of people who directly helped your campaign activities the most, how did you select them? How long were they known by you?

Note: Nudge away from 'the whole village helped'.

_____

B.6. For your biggest rival or runner-up candidate, how much money do you think it must have cost them to complete their campaign activities?

Note: Record open response

_____

B.7. Will you contest the next Pradhan election? What if your panchayat gets reserved for a different category, or gets a mahila reservation?

Note: Record open response

_____

B.8. Has any family member previously won any elected position? It can be for any level such as panchayat Pradhan, ward member, kshetra panchayat, zila panchayat, MLA, MP, and from any place.

( ) Yes

( ) No

( ) Don't Know (DK)

( ) Refused

B.8. How many family members who won elected positions would you like to record details for?

Note: Enter count of family members (1 to 20)

[_____]

> B.8.1. Who all in your family have won these kinds of positions?

Details of Elected Family Member #${B_8_Sr}

B.8.2.a. Name of family member #${B_8_Sr}:

Note: Enter full name (letters only)

_____

B.8.2.b. Relationship of ${B_8_2_a} to you:

( ) Father
( ) Mother
( ) Husband
( ) Wife
( ) Son
( ) Daughter
( ) Brother
( ) Sister
( ) Father-in-law (Sasur)
( ) Mother-in-law (Saas)
( ) Brother-in-law (Devar/Jeth/Sala/Bahnoi)
( ) Sister-in-law (Nanad/Jethani/Devrani/Sali/Bhabhi)
( ) Paternal Uncle (Chacha/Taya)
( ) Paternal Aunt (Chachi/Tai)
( ) Maternal Uncle (Mama)
( ) Maternal Aunt (Mami/Mausi)
( ) Grandfather (Dada/Nana)
( ) Grandmother (Dadi/Nani)
( ) Other
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

B.8.2.b. Other - Specify other relationship of ${B_8_2_a}:

Note: Enter relationship

_____
_____

B.8.3. And when was the first time ${B_8_2_a} won any election? Can you please tell us which year was this?

Note: Enter 4-digit year (e.g. 2010), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused, 888 for Other

[_____]

B.8.4. Does ${B_8_2_a} live together with you in the same house?

( ) Yes

( ) No

( ) Don't Know (DK)

( ) Refused

( ) Other

B.8.4. Other - Specify other living arrangement for ${B_8_2_a}:

_____

_____

B.8.5. When was the last time you met ${B_8_2_a} or talked to them for a long time? Was it maybe this month, this year, 2-3 years ago, or many years ago?

( ) This month

( ) This year

( ) 2-3 years ago

( ) Many years ago

( ) Don't Know (DK)

( ) Refused

B.9. What about political parties? We are not looking for the name of the party, we just want to know your experience. You might like or have a favorite party. But for this question, please think about: is there any party whose workers you contact or work closely with, or one that you are a member of? In this manner, before becoming Pradhan, were you close with any party, please only think as yes or no, without giving the name of the party.

( ) Yes

( ) No

( ) Don't Know (DK)

( ) Refused

( ) Other

B.9. Other - Specify other party relationship before becoming Pradhan:

_____

_____

B.10. And what about now? Do you maintain a relationship with any party regularly, please only answer as yes or no without giving the name of the party. Is it the same party or a different one?

( ) Yes - same party
( ) Yes - different party
( ) No
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused
( ) Other

B.10. Other - Specify other current party relationship:

_____
_____

Section C - Allocation and deservingness

C.1. How important was MGNREGA for helping with citizens' income in your panchayat?

( ) Very important
( ) Not at all important
( ) Somewhat - do not read this option
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

C.2. Is it easy for pradhans to tell which families truly need the work, or is it hard to judge?

( ) Yes (Easy)
( ) No (Hard to judge)
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

C.3. Panchayat resources can sometimes be limited. Imagine that there are 10 people who have demanded work today, but the requirement is only for five people. How would you decide which 5 will get it today?

Note: Record open response

_____

C.4. Generally speaking, in the last 10 years, say before you became pradhan, were there families who used to benefit from MGNREGA but did not really need or do the work?

( ) Yes
( ) No
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

C.5. In your GP, think about how much requirement is there for school buildings, drainage, public facilities beyond what your GP's budget can fund? Can you please tell me on a 0-10 scale: 0 means there is no extra requirements and GP budget is fully self-sufficient. 10 means the budget is fully insufficient to meet requirement.

( ) 1 - No extra requirements / Fully self-sufficient
( ) 2
( ) 3
( ) 4
( ) 5
( ) 6
( ) 7
( ) 8
( ) 9
( ) 10 - Fully insufficient to meet requirement
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

C.6. Have you ever approached an MLA to help by providing extra funds? Imagine you approached, would they help?

Note: Record open response

_____

C.7. For any government program, there are two ways it could be funded. One way is: each state collects its own taxes and funds the programme from its own contribution, according to what it can afford. Another way: central government collects taxes from all states into a big pot, and distributes this pot to each state according to needs, not according to their contribution. In your view, which is better - the central way or the state way?

( ) Central option
( ) State option
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

C.7.A. As per last year, VB GRAM G has replaced MGNREGA. Earlier, states like UP only gave 10 percent of funds for MGNREGA. Net-to-net, some states benefited. For every 100 rupees of MGNREGA given to GPs, 90 percent came from the Central government's big common pot. Now, Central big common pot will give only 60 rupees. State government has to supply 40 rupees as per its own ability. Total-to-total, UP's own program size can change up or down. As per you, which way is better for citizen welfare, the old 90-10 way, or 60-40 state way?

( ) 90-10
( ) 60-40
( ) Other
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

Other (Please specify)

_____
_____

> C.7. As per last year's rule, VB-GRAMG has replaced MGNREGA. It also changes who pays: the state govt pays 40 percent of total cost. So now, each state is more responsible for itself, rich or poor, does not matter.

C.7. Enumerator notes/comments on respondent's reaction (if any):

Note: Record comments if any

_____
_____

C.8. Would you be in favor of panchayats having the power to set and collect their own taxes - for example on land, property, or commercial sales? Or will you prefer all panchayat budgets come from central or state government?

Note: Record open response

_____

> C.9. As per your observations, generally speaking:

C.9.1. Say there are 100 General category families living in your panchayat. What percent regularly demanded NREGS work?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

C.9.2. Say there are 100 OBC category families. What percent regularly demanded NREGS work?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

C.9.3. And among SCs? Say there are 100 SC category families. What percent regularly demanded NREGS work?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

C.10. According to you, which category is most reliant, that is, needs MGNREGA the most?

( ) General
( ) OBC
( ) SC
( ) ST
( ) Other
( ) Don't Know (DK)
( ) Refused

C.10. Other - Specify other reliant category:

_____
_____

Section D - Village battery / covariates

D.1. How many households live in your panchayat?

Note: Enter total households (1-50,000), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.2. What percentage of them would be BPL families as per your knowledge?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.3. And what percentage of families have at least one adult who has finished inter/12th standard?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

> D.4. In our country, there are multiple caste categories, like General / OBC / SC or ST. As per you, if there are total 100 families in your panchayat, what percent are from:

D.4.1. General category?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.4.2. OBC category?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.4.3. SC category?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.5. What percent of families own more than 5 acres of land, or sufficient land to cover all their income needs, or are known as landlords?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

> D.6. As per your observations, can you please tell me:

D.6.1. Say there are 100 General category families in your panchayat. Out of 100, what percent have sufficient land to meet their income needs?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.6.2. Say there are 100 OBC category families in your panchayat. What percent have sufficient land to meet their income needs?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.6.3. Say there are 100 SC category families in your panchayat. What percent have sufficient land to meet their income needs?

Note: Enter percentage (0-100), -777 for DK, -666 for Refused. If range given, record average.

[_____]

D.7. Thinking about earning patterns in your panchayat, what do most families do to meet their living expenses? That is, what is the main source of income in your panchayat?

Note: Record open response

_____

> D.8. As per your observations, can you please tell me, what is top source of income or occupation is among (if farming/cultivation, ask: Is this on their own land, or someone else's):

D.8.1. General category families living in your panchayat?

Note: Record short open response

_____

D.8.2. OBC category families living in your panchayat?

Note: Record short open response

_____

D.8.3. SC category families living in your panchayat?

Note: Record short open response

_____

D.9. Before you were Pradhan, and outside of politics, so as a common citizen - imagine there was a situation where you needed help or there was an emergency. Who would you have first contacted outside your family?

Note: Follow-up: How do you know them? Were they your neighbor, or a member from your own caste/community, or an influential person? If they say generic things like "my friend or padosi or gaon ka koi bhi, nudge towards asking who, how you know them"

_____

D.10. Before you became pradhan, were you usually invited by families outside your own community or religion for weddings, occasions, or to eat at their home? If yes, did you accept the invitation?

( ) Yes and accepted

( ) Yes but not accepted

( ) No such invitation

( ) Don't Know (DK)

( ) Refused

D.11. Before you became pradhan, did you or your household members personally know any big landlord or big businessman or factory owner or previous Pradhan family, or were their acquaintance or close contact?

( ) Yes

( ) No

( ) Don't Know (DK)

( ) Refused

D.12. Many pradhans tend to know all types of families in panchayats very well. Think about the three richest or best-off households in your panchayat. Can you recall the household head's name?

Note: Record verbatim response

_____

D.13. Think of the households who are worst-off, or poorest. These families might have very little income, or they might not have property. Can you recall the head's names for three poorest households?

Note: Record verbatim response first. Ask respondent if they remember the mohalla/tola or full name.

_____

D.14. Is there anything you wish to share or highlight about yourself or your village that is important for your role as pradhan? Maybe we did not get to discuss it. This will help the researchers learn directly from your perspective.

Note: Record open response

_____

Section E: Enumerator's own endline (not asked to pradhans)

E.1.1. Enumerator Name / ID

Note: Select your Enumerator Name / ID

( ) Enumerator 01
( ) Enumerator 02
( ) Enumerator 03
( ) Enumerator 04
( ) Enumerator 05
( ) Enumerator 06
( ) Enumerator 07
( ) Enumerator 08
( ) Enumerator 09
( ) Enumerator 10
( ) Other

E.1.1. Other - Specify Enumerator Name / ID:

_____
_____

E.1.2. Enumerator Gender

( ) Male
( ) Female
( ) Other

E.2. Enumerator observation: Anyone else present?

( ) Yes
( ) No

E.3. Enumerator observation: Was anyone else helping/prompting or giving answers directly instead of candidate?

( ) Yes - helping or prompting
( ) Yes - someone else primarily responded
( ) No - candidate responded
( ) Other

E.4. Enumerator observation: Primary respondent's gender

( ) Male

( ) Female

( ) Other

E.5. From your own assessment, on a 1-10 scale, how comfortable was the intended candidate with answering?

( ) 1

( ) 2

( ) 3

( ) 4

( ) 5

( ) 6

( ) 7

( ) 8

( ) 9

( ) 10

E.6. Out of 10, to what extent were there any incidents or disturbances during the interview? (1 = none, 10 = maximum)

( ) 1

( ) 2

( ) 3

( ) 4

( ) 5

( ) 6

( ) 7

( ) 8

( ) 9

( ) 10

E.7. [If No in A5] Out of 10, how confident are you that you noted responses accurately for open ended questions?

( ) 1
( ) 2
( ) 3
( ) 4
( ) 5
( ) 6
( ) 7
( ) 8
( ) 9
( ) 10

E.8. Any notes or concerns you wish to share:

Note: Record open response

_____
_____
